

Smriti Ganapathi

✉ smriti.ganapathi@gmail.com

🌐 <https://smriti-ganapathi.github.io/>

Education

- 2027 (Expected)  **PhD in Public Policy, University of Chicago**
PhD scholarship by The Pearson Institute
Dissertation Title - "Enforcement, Norms, Framing: How Institutional Decisions Shape Gender-Based Violence"
- 2018  **M.Sc. Economics and Social Sciences, Bocconi University**
Admitted with a merit scholarship
Dissertation Title - "Tackling violence against women: can laws change perceptions?"

Works in Progress

- *The Impact of Victim-Centric Institutions on Sex Offense Perpetration* [JMP]
with Daniela Horta-Saenz & Mazeeda Karani
- *Policing Intimate Partner Violence: Curbing Abuse or Shifting It?*
- *The Impact of Social Movements on Rape Rhetoric: Evidence from India*
- *What is Truly Cultural? The Impact of Historical Information on Social Norms*

Policy Writing

- Oeindrila Dube, Smriti Ganapathi, Soeren J. Henn, and James A. Robinson. 2020. "Farmer-Herder Conflict in Nigeria's Middle Belt: Evidence from 288 Communities." *Policy Report*.

Employment

Teaching Experience

- Oct 2023  **Instructor: Program Evaluation**, University of Chicago
Designed and taught an online intensive course for international policy students & practitioners.
- Feb 2026  **Guest Lecturer: Violence in Schools**, University of Chicago
- Oct 2022 - Mar 2026  **Teaching Assistant**, University of Chicago
Leading TA sessions:
Statistics (Master's; 2024, 2026), Program Evaluation (Master's; 2023), Advanced Microeconomics (PhD; 2023, 2024).
Supervising research:
Education & Economic Development (BA; 2026)

Research Experience

- Jul 2019 – Jul 2021  **Pre-doctoral Research Assistant**, University of Chicago
Quasi-experimental projects & RCTs around conflict and gender.
- Jun 2018 – Dec 2018  **Field Research Associate**, J-PAL
RCT on women's and children's health, overseeing primary data collection from over 10,000 households in 223 villages in India.

Employment (continued)

Multilateral Organizations

- Mar 2019 – Jul 2019  **Evaluation Intern**, International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)
Synthesized findings from 30 projects on community-driven development.
- Jan 2018 – Apr 2018  **Intern - Crime Statistics**, UN Office on Drugs and Crime
Compiled statistics on gender-based violence and contributed to the “Global Study on Homicide” 2019 report.

Grants & Scholarships

- 2026; 2023  \$16,000, Development Economics Research Fund, University of Chicago & Norwegian School of Economics – “Sexual Violence in South Africa”.
- 2026  Center for Gender & Sexuality Studies Grant.
- 2022  \$3,000, Research funds by The Pearson Institute.
- 2021  PhD scholarship by The Pearson Institute.
- 2015  Merit scholarship for Master’s degree by Bocconi University.

Conference Presentations

- Jul 12-14, 2026  **Violence Prevention Research Conference**
Portsmouth, NH, USA
- Oct 06-09, 2025  **International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse and Neglect (ISPCAN) Congress**
Vilnius, Lithuania
- May 16-17, 2019  **European Conference on Multi-Agency Response to Gender-Based Violence**
Vilnius, Lithuania
- Apr 12-13, 2017  **Second International Symposium on Gender, Law and Constitutions**
Washington DC, USA

Skills

- Languages  English, Hindi & Tamil – Native;
French & Italian – Intermediate;
Arabic & Hawaiian – Basic
- Coding  R, Stata, Python, LaTeX

References

- Oeindrila Dube: odube@uchicago.edu
- Anjali Adukia: adukia@uchicago.edu
- Chris Blattman: blattman@uchicago.edu